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Zachary Batist

AREAS OF EXPERTISE

- Research data management
- Open research infrastructure
- Scientific software development
- Community-driven infrastructure
- Scholar of scientific practice
- Critical and feminist meta-research
- Bridging policy with real-world experiences
- Pan-disciplinary experience and outlook

CURRENT POSITION

2025 – **Postdoctoral Researcher**
Covid-19 Immunity Task Force Databank
Department of Epidemiology, Biostatistics and Occupational Health
School of Public and Global Health, McGill University

EDUCATION

2023 **PhD**, Faculty of Information, University of Toronto
Archaeological data work as continuous and collaborative practice

2015 **MA**, Department of Anthropology, McMaster University
Obsidian Circulation Networks in Southwest Asia and Anatolia: A Comparative Approach

2012 **BA**, Directed Interdisciplinary Studies, Carleton University

2009 **DEC**, Social Sciences, Dawson College

PAST POSITIONS

2018 – 2023 **Research Assistant**
E–CURATORS: Pervasive Digital Curation Activities, Objects and Infrastructures in Archaeological Research and Communication
Faculty of Information, University of Toronto

2016 – 2021 **Database Manager**
Stelida Naxos Archaeology Project

2007 – 2009 **Research Assistant**
Molecular Pharmacology Laboratory
Lady Davis Institute for Medical Research

PUBLICATIONS

JOURNAL ARTICLES

2026 Farahnak, F., W.S. El-Deiry, Y.A. Lussier, R. Kurzrock, S. Magidi, C. Bresson, S.A. Enger, and 40 other authors, **Z. Batist**, Y. Quintana & G. Batist. **Worldwide Innovative Network (WIN) Consortium: Building a Common Global Cancer Database.** Nature Reviews in Clinical Oncology 12(8):e2500720. DOI: 10.1200/GO-25-00720.

2025 Batist, Z. **Balancing situated and objective representations in archaeological fieldwork.** Advances in Archaeological Practice. 13(4):514-527. DOI: 10.1017/aap.2025.10101.

2025 Batist, Z. **Locating creative agency in archaeological data work.** Peer Community in Archaeology. zackbatist.info/locating-creative-agency | DOI: 10.17613/8eqy4-n1m82.

2024 Batist, Z & Roe, J. **Open archaeology, open source? Collaborative practices in an emerging community of archaeological software engineers.** Internet Archaeology 67. DOI: 10.11141/ia.67.13.

2024 Batist, Z. **On the Value of Informal Communication in Archaeological Data Work.** Open Archaeology. 10(1):20240014. DOI: 10.1515/opar-2024-0014.

2024 Batist, Z. **Does not compute! Accounting for social and situated experiences while integrating and analyzing obsidian sourcing data.** Archeologia e Calcolatori. 35(2):47-54. DOI: 10.19282/ac.35.2.2024.06.

2021 Batist, Z, Masters, V, Torma, TC, Ferris, N, Huvila, I, Ross, S, Carter, WM & Dallas, C. **Figurations of Digital Archaeological Practice in Two Mediterranean Fieldwork Projects.** Open Archaeology (Special Issue on Archaeological Practice on Shifting Grounds) 7(1):1731-1755. DOI: 10.1515/opar-2020-0217.

2021 Contreras, D, Batist, Z, Zogheib, C & Carter, T. **Matching Pragmatic Lithic Analysis and Proper Data Architecture: The QuARI R Shiny Database Interface.** Advances in Archaeological Practice 9(4):299-311. DOI: 10.1017/aap.2021.11.

2023 Batist, Z & Roe, J. **Open-archaeo: a resource for documenting archaeological software development practices.** Journal of Open Archaeology Data. 11(9):1-7. DOI: 10.5334/joad.111.

2017 Carter, T, Batist, Z, Campeau, K, Garfinkel, Y & Streit, K. **Investigating Pottery Neolithic Socio-Economic "Regression" in the Southern Levant: Characterising Obsidian Consumption at Sha'ar Hagolan (N. Israel).** Journal of Archaeological Science: Reports 15:305-317. DOI: 10.1016/j.jasrep.2017.08.016.

2014 Freund, KP & Batist, Z. **Sardinian Obsidian Circulation and Early Maritime Navigation in the Neolithic as Shown through Social Network Analysis.** Journal of Island and Coastal Archaeology 9(3):364-380. DOI: 10.1080/15564894.2014.881937.

2009 Loignon, M, Miao, W, Hu, L, Bouchard, A, Bismar, TA, Scrivens, PJ, Mann, K, Basik, M, Fiset, PO, Batist, Z & Batist, G. **Frequent Nrf2 depletion due to Cul3 overexpression in breast cancer is associated with sensitivity to carcinogens, oxidative stress and chemotherapy.** Molecular Cancer Therapeutics 8(8):2432-2440. DOI: 10.1158/1535-7163.MCT-08-1186.

Additional Articles in Progress

In progress Batist, Z, Ouellet, M., Khezri, S., Murphy, T., Noza, A., Abbasgholizadeh-Rahimi, S., Bourque, G. & Buckeridge, D. **LLM-assisted topic modelling of Canadian COVID-19 Immunity Task Force data sharing operations.** zackbatist.info/CITF-emails/topic-modelling

In progress Bernier, A., Baltzan, I., Wey, T., Batist, Z. & Fortier, I. **Data Governance in Longitudinal Mother-Child Cohorts: An Empirical Assessment of the Canadian ReACH Studies.**

In progress Khezri, S., Murphy, T., **Batist, Z.**, Noza, A., Ouellet, M., Wey, T., Nechba, A., Wissa, R., Bernier, A., Zawati, M., Mazer, B., Oxlade, O., Evans, T. & Buckeridge, D. **The CITF Databank: A harmonized dataset of SARS-CoV-2 immunity data from Canadian research studies.**

In progress Batist, Z., Julie Lund & Isak Roalkvam **Bibliometric analysis of Viking Age Research.**

In progress Batist, Z. & Shirin Abbasinejad Enger. **Positive mentorship in the history of radiology.**

BOOK CONTRIBUTIONS

2018 Graham, S, Gupta, N, Smith, J, Angourakis, A, Reinhard, A, Ellenberger, K, Batist, Z, Rivard, J, Marwick, B, Carter, WM, Compton, B, Blades, R, Wood, C & Nobles, G. **The Open Digital Archaeology Textbook.** eCampus Ontario. o-date.github.io
🎗 Award for Outstanding Work in Digital Archaeology, Archaeological Institute of America

CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS

In review Batist, Z. **Data Management is People Management: On Abstraction of Data and Labor in Archaeological Projects.** Data and Technology Politics in Archaeology Workshop. zackbatist.info/data-tech-poli-arch (preprint)

2022 Batist, Z. **Documenting archaeological knowledge construction as information practices.** Human History and Digital Future. Proceedings of the 46th Conference on Computer Applications and Quantitative Methods in Archaeology. Tübingen University Press. DOI: 10.15496/publikation-94869.

SOFTWARE & DATA

SOFTWARE

2020 – 2021 **Queryable Artefact Record Interface (QuARI)** A database interface designed to facilitate the irregular, iterative, and non-linear workflows commonly employed in lithic analysis. GitHub: zackbatist/QuARI.

2025 – present **qc-atelier** A series of utilities to support the Qualitative Coding software package. GitHub: zackbatist/CITF-Postdoc.

DATASETS

2018 – present **open-archaeo** A comprehensive list of open source archaeological software and resources. open-archaeo.info | DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.8299651.

2014 – 2017 **Database of Obsidian Sourcing Studies (DObsiSS)** A listing of chemically characterized archaeological obsidian, compiled from published journal articles, excavation reports, conference papers, and other scholarly records. DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.55848.

OTHER OPEN INITIATIVES

2026 – present **Directory of Canadian Metaresearch Initiatives** Built for the Canadian Metaresearch Data Challenge; supports discovery of researchers working on overlapping questions and analysis of the field's development. zackbatist.info/CMDC

2025 – present **Digital Archaeology Maintainathon** A week-long drive to encourage maintenance of code and data, and to help instill good para-coding practices among archaeological researchers. sslarch.github.io/maintainathon

2024 – present **Diamond Open Archaeology** A listing of diamond open access archaeology journals. DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.15026607.

ART & OUTREACH

2026 **Decisions and Actions at the Trowel's Edge** Interactive role-playing scenes about archaeological data work, drawn from research on how archaeologists make decisions in the field. zackbatist.info/data-work-game

2022 – present **Personal blog**, zackbatist.info/posts

GRANTS & AWARDS

GRANTS & FELLOWSHIPS

2026 **CIHR Project Grant**, Priority Area: Pandemic Preparedness and Health Emergencies Research. Deriving insights for research data sharing from a large-scale data sharing initiative in Canada. ($100,000)

2019 – 2021 **SSHRC Doctoral Fellowship**. Archaeological data curation as continuous and collaborative practice. Award ID: 752-2019-2233. ($20,000)

2019 **Research Travel Grant** ($500)
Faculty of Arts and Science, University of Toronto

2017 **Joseph and Maria Shaw Graduate Student Travel Award** ($500)
The Archaeology Centre, University of Toronto

2015 **McMaster University Travel Scholarship for OpenCon 2015** ($2500)
McMaster University Library, McMaster University

2015 **Edith M. Wightman Travel Scholarship** ($1000)
School of Graduate Studies, McMaster University

2015 **Travel Assistance Grant** ($500)
School of Graduate Studies, McMaster University

2015 **Graduate Student Travel Award** ($120)
Archaeological Institute of America

2014 **McMaster University Travel Scholarship for OpenCon 2014** ($2500, declined)
McMaster University Library, McMaster University

2011 **Full Tuition Scholarship** (declined)
Digital Humanities Summer Institute, University of Victoria

AWARDS & HONOURS

2014 **Robert P. Wolff Thesis Prize**
Society for Philosophy & Culture, McMaster University

2012 **Dean's Honour List**
Carleton University

2012 **Michael Kelway Oliver Scholarship**
Carleton University

TEACHING

TEACHING ASSISTANT

2020 **Curatorial Practice** (MSL 2000)
Faculty of Information, University of Toronto

2017 – 2020 **Representing, Documenting, and Accessing the Cultural Record** (INF 1321)
Faculty of Information, University of Toronto

2017 **Information Policy, Regulation and Law** (INF 2181)
Faculty of Information, University of Toronto

2016 **Archaeology and Popular Culture** (ANTH 2PC3)
Department of Anthropology, McMaster University

2014 – 2015 **World Archaeology** (ANTH 2WA3E)
Department of Anthropology, McMaster University

2012, 2015 **Introduction to Anthropology: Identity, Race and Power** (ANTH 1AB3E)
Department of Anthropology, McMaster University

2013 **Introduction to Anthropology: Sex, Food and Death** (ANTH 1AA3)
Department of Anthropology, McMaster University

WORKSHOPS & SHORT COURSES

2022 March **Using Qualitative Data Analysis Software**
The Ethnography Lab Methods Café: Software in Ethnographic Research Methods
Department of Anthropology, University of Toronto

2018 January **Designing and Implementing Relational Databases**
Archaeological Information Interest Group, The Archaeology Centre, University of Toronto
GitHub: zackbatist/archaeo-db-workshop.

PRESENTATIONS

INVITED PRESENTATIONS

2026 October **AI and Peer Review**
Human-Centered AI Reading Group, Mila / Québec Artificial Intelligence Institute
zackbatist.info/ai-peer-review
GitHub: zackbatist/ai-peer-review.

2026 March **Investigating archaeological information commons as coordinated, collective and community-driven action**
Digital Archaeology and Heritage Lab Digital Lunch Series
Department of Archaeology, University of York

2025 December **Archaeological Data Work in Practice**
Digital Heritage Seminar, Instructed by Piraye Hacıgüzeller
Antwerp Cultural Heritage Sciences (ARCHES), University of Antwerp

2025 October **Open Data in Practice**
INF 649: Digital Curation, Instructed by Ilja Frissen
School of Information Studies, McGill University

2025 April **Articulating data harmonization as pragmatic, collaborative experiences**
McGill Clinical and Health Information Research Group
School of Population and Global Health, McGill University

2024 November **Curating archaeological research data in practice, from the field to the archive**
INF 649: Digital Curation, Instructed by Ilja Frissen
School of Information Studies, McGill University

2024 October
Exploring collaborative practices in archaeological software development
A coffee talk for Dr. Jean-Baptiste Poline and colleagues
Neuro Data Science ORIGAMI Lab, McGill University

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2026 June
Batist, Z. **Where do we draw the line? On legitimate uses of AI and open information commons, and commitment to community values.** Paper to be presented at the 2026 Implementing New Knowledge Environments (INKE) Gathering. Canadian Society for Digital Humanities / Digital Humanities Summer Institute, Université de Montréal.

2026 April
Batist, Z, Roalkvam, I. & Lund, J. **A Protocol for Analyzing Citational Practice in Viking Age Archaeology.** Citational Politics and Practices in Viking Age Archaeology and Beyond. Department of Archaeology, Conservation and History, University of Oslo.

2026 April
Roe, J., Batist, Z, Yates, J.A.F. & Titolo, A. **archaeo.social and archaeo.dev: decentralised, collective digital infrastructure for archaeologists.** 53rd Computer Applications and Quantitative Methods in Archaeology Conference. Vienna, Austria.

2023 December
Batist, Z. **Does not compute! Accounting for social and situated experiences while integrating and analyzing obsidian sourcing data.** Paper presented at ArcheoFOSS XVII – Open Science and Archaeology: Archiving the Knowledge. University of Turin.

2023 February
Batist, Z. **Documenting the collaborative commitments that support data sharing within archaeological project collectives.** Paper presented at Digital Archaeology Bern 2023. Bern Computational and Digital Archaeology lab, University of Bern.

2021 June
Batist, Z & Roe, J. **Open archaeology: a survey of collaborative software engineering in archaeological research.** Paper presented at the 49th Computer Applications and Quantitative Methods in Archaeology Conference. Limassol, Cyprus.

2019 September
Batist, Z. **Distributing Knowledge Of Digital Workflows Via Workshops And Support Groups.** Lightning talk presented at Our Networks, Re: Infrastructure. Toronto.

2019 October
Batist, Z. **Untangling and extending the discursive relations mediated by archaeological data through grounded research.** Paper presented at On shifting grounds – the study of archaeological practices in a changing world, COST-Arkwork and the Department of History and Archaeology, University of Crete. Rethymno, Crete.

2018 April
Batist, Z. **Documenting archaeological knowledge construction as socially-embedded information practices.** Paper presented at PhD Research Days 2018, Faculty of Information, University of Toronto. Toronto, Ontario.

2018 March
Batist, Z. **Documenting archaeological knowledge construction as distributed information practices.** Paper presented at the 46th Computer Applications and Quantitative Methods in Archaeology Conference. Tübingen, Germany.

2017 May
Batist, Z & Dallas, C. **A view from the bridge: human- and thing-centred approaches to research practice, disciplinary discourse and local engagement with the archaeological record.** Paper presented at TAG (North America) 2017 - The Medium is the Message: Media and Mediation in Archaeology. Toronto, Ontario.

2017 March — Carter, T, Campeau, K, Batist, Z, Garfinkel, Y, Rosenberg, D, Rowan, Y & Streit, K. **Social Interaction at Distance Over the Long Term: Obsidian Sourcing from the Southern Levant (9th – 4th millennia cal BC).** Paper presented at the Society for American Archaeology 82nd Annual Meeting. Vancouver, British Columbia.

2017 January — Batist, Z. **Identifying Obsidian Procurement Habits during the Pre-Pottery Neolithic in the Levant using Network Analysis.** Poster presented at the Archaeological Institute of America 118th Annual Meeting. Toronto, Ontario.

2015 January — Batist, Z. **The Database of Obsidian Sourcing Studies (DObsiSS): Using Git for Collaborative Management of Archaeological Data.** Poster presented at the American Archaeological Institute 116th Annual Meeting. New Orleans, Louisiana.

2014 March — Batist, Z. **An Examination of Obsidian Circulation Patterns in Terms of Relational and Geographical Distance in Southwest Asia and Anatolia from the Epi-Palaeolithic to Chalcolithic Periods (14000 – 5700 B.P.).** Paper presented at Archaeological Sciences and the Ancient Mediterranean Environment. The Archaeological Centre, University of Toronto.

2014 January — Batist, Z. **Using Network Analysis to Examine Relative Resource Procurement Strategies in Anatolia and Southwest Asia from the Epipaleolithic to Chalcolithic Periods (14,000 – 5700 BP).** Paper presented at the American Archaeological Institute 115th Annual Meeting. Chicago, Illinois.

2013 November — Freund, KP & Batist, Z. **Tracking the Circulation of Sardinian Obsidian using Network Analysis: Lithic Procurement, Cultural Interaction, and Early Maritime Navigation in the Neolithic.** Paper presented at Networks of maritime connectivity in the ancient Mediterranean: Structure, continuity, and change over the longue durée. The Archaeology Centre, University of Toronto. Toronto, Ontario.

2013 September — Batist, Z. **Using network analysis to examine obsidian assemblage variability in Anatolia and Southwest Asia from the Epi-Palaeolithic to Chalcolithic periods (14000 – 5700 BP).** Paper presented at The Future of Historical Network Research Conference. Historical Network Research, University of Hamburg. Hamburg, Germany.

2012 March — Batist, Z. **Eat, Drink and Be Networked: Feasting and Bronze Age Networks.** Invited panelist at the Colloquium on Digital History and the Transnational History of Nursing. Department of History, Carleton University. Ottawa, Ontario.

ACADEMIC SERVICE & AFFILIATIONS

OTHER AFFILIATIONS

2026 – present — **Independent Visiting Researcher**, Mila / Québec Artificial Intelligence Institute

COMMUNITY LEADERSHIP

2025 – present — **Founder and Coordinator**, Digital Archaeology Maintainathon
sslarch.github.io/maintainathon

2025 Summer — **Interim Coordinator** (and member since 2019), Scientific Scripting Languages in Archaeology Special Interest Group (sslarch). Computer Applications in Archaeology.
sslarch.github.io

2018 – present — **Founder and Maintainer**, open-archaeo
open-archaeo.info

2022 – present **Community Moderator**, archaeo.social
about.archaeo.social

2022 **Peer Mentor**, UofT Coders Peer Mentorship Program
UofT Coders, University of Toronto

2017 – 2021 **Founder and Coordinator**, Archaeological Information Interest Group
The Archaeology Centre, University of Toronto

2013 – 2014 **Webmaster**, Nexus: The Canadian Student Journal of Anthropology
Department of Anthropology, McMaster University

COMMITTEES

2019 – 2020 **Graduate Student Union Faculty Representative**
Faculty of Information Doctoral Student Association, University of Toronto

2016 – 2019 **Tech Fund Committee Member and Coordinator**
Faculty of Information Doctoral Student Association, University of Toronto

2013 – 2014 **Graduate Student Association Faculty Representative**
Faculty of Social Sciences, McMaster University

CONFERENCE & PANEL ORGANIZER

2026 April **Citational Politics and Practices in Viking Age Archaeology and Beyond**
Co-organized with Julie Lund & Isak Roalkvam. Department of Archaeology, Conservation and History, University of Oslo. zackbatist.info/BibVik/workshop

2023 December **archaeo.social: archaeology in the Fediverse and the future of scholarly social media**
Panel convened for ArcheoFOSS XVII with Joe Roe. University of Turin.

2014 **Second Annual Interdisciplinary Colloquium**
Co-organized with Priscilla Medeiros. Faculty of Social Sciences, McMaster University

INTEREST GROUPS

2026 – present Human-Centered AI Reading Group (ianarawjo.github.io/mila-hcai)
Mila / Québec Artificial Intelligence Institute

2018 – 2022 UofT Coders (uoftcoders.github.io)
University of Toronto

2018 – 2019 Digitality Reading Group
University of Toronto

2017 – 2019 Archaeological Theory Interest Group
The Archaeology Centre, University of Toronto

2017 – 2021 Archaeological Information Interest Group
The Archaeology Centre, University of Toronto

REVIEWER

- Open Information Science
- Computer Applications in Archaeology
- Peer Community in Archaeology
- Advances in Archaeological Practice

CERTIFICATIONS

- The Carpentries Instructor Training

LANGUAGES

English Mother tongue

French Basic reading and writing